GHANA EDUCATION SERVICE (GES)

PROFESSIONAL LESSON NOTE

SOCIAL STUDIES: CULTURE AND NATIONAL IDENTITY

Name of School: Eden Academy

Name of Teacher: Michael and Sandy

Date: 22nd October 2026

Week: 8

Class: Basic 9 (JHS 3)

Duration: 60 minutes

Subject: Social Studies

Topic: Culture and National Identity

Strand: Sense of Purpose

Sub-strand: Culture and National Identity

1. CURRICULUM REFERENCE

Content Standard: B9.3.1.1 — verify the exact wording and code against the curriculum edition used by the school.

Reference: NaCCA Common Core Programme Curriculum for Social Studies, Basic 7–10.

Note: This is a GES-style sample lesson note, not a verbatim official GES-issued lesson plan.

2. PREVIOUS KNOWLEDGE

Learners have observed cultural practices, traditional festivals, national symbols and ceremonies in their communities.

3. LEARNING INDICATORS

By the end of the lesson, learners should be able to:

1. Explain the meanings of culture and national identity.
2. Identify elements of Ghanaian culture.
3. Identify symbols, music and ceremonies associated with Ghanaian identity.
4. Explain how culture promotes national identity.
5. Suggest ways of preserving Ghanaian culture.

4. CORE COMPETENCIES

Critical Thinking and Problem-Solving: Examine how cultural practices influence national identity.

Communication and Collaboration: Discuss cultural practices in groups and present findings.

Cultural Identity and Global Citizenship: Appreciate Ghanaian culture and respect cultural diversity.

Creativity and Innovation: Create posters showing Ghanaian cultural symbols.

5. TEACHING AND LEARNING RESOURCES

Ghana's national flag; pictures of the Coat of Arms; pictures of traditional festivals; samples or pictures of Kente and traditional smocks; charts showing Adinkra symbols; pictures of traditional musical instruments; chalkboard or whiteboard.

6. KEY WORDS

Culture, national identity, tradition, customs, symbols, patriotism, national unity and cultural diversity.

7. INTRODUCTION (5 MINUTES)

Teacher's activities: Display pictures of Ghana's national flag, Kente cloth and a traditional festival. Ask learners to identify them and explain what they tell us about Ghana.

Learners' activities: Observe the pictures, identify the items and share experiences of cultural practices in their communities.

Expected responses: The national flag represents Ghana; Kente is a traditional Ghanaian textile; festivals reflect community customs and traditions.

Lesson introduction: Introduce the topic, Culture and National Identity.

8. LESSON DEVELOPMENT

Stage / Time	Teacher's activities	Learners' activities	Content
Step 1 Meaning of culture (10 min)	Explain culture and give examples. Ask learners to identify practices in their communities.	Listen, give examples and discuss cultural practices.	**Culture** is the total way of life of a group of people, including beliefs, values, language, food, dressing, music, dance, customs and traditions. **Examples:** marriage and naming ceremonies; banku, fufu and kenkey; Kente and smocks; Adowa, Agbadza and Kpanlogo; festivals such as Homowo, Hogbetsotso and Kundum.
Step 2 National identity (10 min)	Explain national identity. Display national symbols and ask how they identify Ghana.	Identify symbols and explain how they represent Ghana.	**National identity** is the sense of belonging to a country and sharing aspects of its history, symbols, values and traditions. **Examples:** national flag, Coat of Arms, national anthem, national pledge, Black Star and Independence Day celebrations.
Step 3 Importance of culture (15 min)	Divide learners into groups to discuss how culture promotes national identity. Guide presentations and correct misconceptions.	Work in groups, discuss and present findings.	Culture promotes national unity; preserves history; encourages patriotism; promotes tourism; preserves indigenous languages; encourages mutual respect; creates a sense of belonging; and can support economic development through crafts and festivals.
Step 4 Symbols, music and ceremonies (10 min)	Display symbols and discuss patriotic music and national ceremonies.	Identify symbols, mention patriotic songs and ceremonies, and explain their importance.	The national flag, Coat of Arms and Black Star represent Ghana. The national anthem and patriotic songs encourage love for the country. Independence Day celebrations and national commemorations remind citizens of shared history and values.
Step 5 Preservation of culture (5 min)	Ask learners to suggest practical ways to preserve Ghanaian culture.	Suggest ways young people can contribute.	Teach indigenous languages; document oral traditions; celebrate festivals responsibly; teach traditional music, dances and crafts; respect cultural differences; preserve artefacts and historical sites; pass on traditional knowledge.

9. LESSON SUMMARY

Culture is the total way of life of a group of people. National identity is the sense of belonging to a country. Ghanaian cultural practices, national symbols, patriotic music and ceremonies help promote national identity, unity and patriotism. Citizens should preserve valuable cultural practices while respecting the rights and cultures of others.

10. EVALUATION

1. Define culture.
2. What is national identity?
3. State four elements of Ghanaian culture.
4. Mention four national symbols of Ghana.
5. Explain four ways culture promotes national identity.

6. State three ways Ghanaian culture can be preserved.

7. Explain two ways national ceremonies promote unity.

8. State two differences between culture and national identity.

11. EXPECTED ANSWERS

1. Culture is the total way of life of a group of people.

2. National identity is the sense of belonging to a particular country and sharing aspects of its history, symbols and values.

3. Language, food, dressing, music and dance.

4. National flag, Coat of Arms, national anthem and Black Star.

5. Culture promotes unity, preserves history and traditions, encourages patriotism and creates a sense of belonging.

6. Teach indigenous languages, celebrate traditional festivals responsibly, and teach traditional music and dances.

7. National ceremonies bring people together and remind citizens of their shared history.

8. Culture is the way of life of a group; national identity is the sense of belonging to a country. Culture includes local customs and traditions, while national identity includes shared national symbols, history and values.

12. HOMEWORK

1. Explain five reasons Ghanaian culture should be preserved.

2. Identify three traditional festivals celebrated in Ghana and name the communities associated with them.

3. Explain three ways young people can promote Ghanaian national identity.

13. TEACHER'S REFLECTION

Were learners able to explain culture and national identity? .....

Could learners identify Ghanaian cultural elements and national symbols? .....

What areas need improvement? .....

Teacher's comments: .....

Signature .....